

ARTIST CAREER DOSSIER

ALEJANDRO ESCUDER

composer · pianist · music educator · sociologist

www.alejandroescuder.com

Biography (short)

Alejandro is a **Composer, Pianist** and **Music Educator** formed in Spain and Austria as a classical and contemporary music pianist and composer as well as in jazz, modern music and improvisation.

Graduated in **Piano** and **Music Composition** by the Higher Conservatory of Music “Salvador Seguí” of Castellon (Spain), **Master in Media Composition and Applied Music**, and **Electroacoustic Composition** by the University of Music and Performing Arts of Vienna and **Sociologist** by the University of Vienna.

He is **Music Theory, Harmony and Piano** teacher at the [Conservatory “Calasancio” of Music and Dance](#). Also, he teaches **Orchestration, Orchestral Mockup Production** and **Composition for Film** at [Cinematic Composing](#).

His catalog of works is very varied, demonstrating capacity to compose in a very wide variety of musical fields. Within them we can highlight his works for chamber music, electroacoustic, film music and video game music and sound design.

He has also conducted his own pieces, written and produced commercial music and **Sound Design** for Videogames.

His other two greatest interest are **Sociology and Education**, beside **research** in both fields related to music.



As a composer, he has been student of Ferrer Ferran, Claudia Montero, Voro García, Reinhard Karger, Karlheinz Essl, Christian Mühlbacher, Johannes Kretz, Paul Urbanek; and he has also participated in courses and seminars given by important composers and personalities such as Anton Garcia Abril, James Horner, Hans Zimmer, David Newman, Héctor Parra, Toshio Hosokawa, Cristóbal Halffter, Lorin Maazel, Gustavo Dudamel, Beat Furrer and Georg Friedrich Haas among others.

His composition style embraces a large variety of music styles and aesthetics. He can be defined as a very eclectic composer, demonstrating proficiency in a very wide variety of musical fields:

- **Concert and contemporary music:** Trance (Sextet); Paradigmen (String Quartet); Superb (Orchestra), Self-Destruction (Wind Orchestra); Arc sur Canvas (Cello+Electronics) Electro-Thunder Harp (Harp+Sampler), Continuum (Trombone+Organ); Pas de Deux (Pno+Cl+Vc) ...
- **Jazz:** Tekamolo (Big Band, 2013); Spanish Ballade (Big Band, 2016) ...
- **Theater, Music Theater, Performances:** Bahnhof des Lebens (2014); #NoWayBack (2017) ...
- **Music for Film, Docs and Spots:** Tagomago (2013); Running is our life (2013); Hide and Seek...
- **Music and Sound Design for Videogames:** Adaline (iOS), Schools of Magic (iOS)...
- **Songwriting and music production:** Game of Life (2016); I'm a Minister (2018) ...

As a pianist, he has been student of Agustín Martínez and Juan Carlos Cornelles. He has also extended his piano training with Carles Marín, Carlos Apellániz, Brenno Ambrosini, Basilio Fernández, Bogdan Kulakowski...

In Vienna he has expanded his piano skills, learning modern music and free improvisation with Manon Liu Winter, and jazz with Paul Urbanek.

His experience as a pianist is very wide. He has given concerts as a soloist, as accompanist, with Orchestra as well as with Wind Orchestra (MDW). He has been member of the Big Band of the Conservatory during 3 years. Also, he works regularly as a pianist in some of the most emblematic Coffeehouses of Vienna (such as Café Central).

He can be defined as an all-road pianist, from **classical** music to **jazz**, pop **arrangements**, and **improvisation**.

As a music educator, he combines his career as a composer and pianist with his passion for pedagogy. He has been dedicated to music education for over 10 years, in which he has worked in music schools, Volkshochschule, as well as with over 50 private students.

He constantly tries to improve the quality of the music lessons and the way in which children and adults learn music through modern methods such as **music integration**, **psychopedagogy**, the use of **Apps**, **E-Learning** and **new technologies**, and other concepts such as the *flipped classroom* for theoretical subjects.

Additionally, he is a sociologist by the University of Vienna and works as an Arranger and in Music Preparation for important events such as Hollywood in Vienna, the Lifeball, and more recently in the Tour of "World of Hans Zimmer".

Career Timeline (Highlights)

2008

- Starts **Piano** and **Music Composition** studies at Higher Conservatory of Music “Salvador Seguí” in Castellón (Spain)

2009

- Finalist Young Performers Competition “Vila de Bechi” – Pianist
- Concert Tour with the Symphony Orchestra of Higher Conservatory of Music of Castellón – Pianist

2011

- Starts **Pianist in the Big Band** of the Higher Conservatory of Music of Castellón

2012

- Première *Reflections* for Flute and live electronics (Rafelbunyol Auditorium)

2013

- Commission of *Self-destruction* for Symphonic Band, as a mandatory work for a Symphonic Bands Contest.
- Commission of *Elegy, Fantasy, Rock!* for Cello and Piano for a Higher Conservatory of Music of Castellón Cello Competition.
- Première *Arc sur canvas* for Cello and live electronics (Rafelbunyols Auditorium)
- Concert *Swing the Big Bands* (arrangements of Swing classics for Big Band) – Pianist and Arranger.
- Graduated in Piano Performance and Music Composition** by the Higher Conservatory of Music “Salvador Seguí” in Castellón (Spain)
- Starts **Media Composition, Jazz and Arrangements** studies at University of Music and Performing Arts Vienna.
- Première *Tekamolo* for Big Band in Porgy and Bess – Composer, Conductor.
- Composition Course with Toshio Hosokawa and Héctor Parra.

2014

- Starts working in Café Diglas Wollzeile – Pianist
- Starts working in **Sonotrigger** – Sound Designer / Composer
- Starts Sociology studies at University of Vienna

2015

- Première *Paradigmen* for Bamboo Flute, Pipa and String Quartet (NEW PIPA Project - MDW)
- Première *State of Mind* for piano solo (composition-improvisation)
- Concert with the *Interactive Orchestra* (Festival MIXTUR – Barcelona) – Pianist

2016

- Arranger by **Hollywood in Vienna 2016**
- Starts working in Café Diglas im Schottenstift – Pianist
- Starts working in Café Central – Pianist
- Starts working in **Vienna Music Angels (Music Preparation)**
- Première *Spanish Ballade* for Big Band in Porgy and Bess – Composer, Pianist, Conductor.

2017

- Graduated **Magister Art. of Media Composition and Applied Music**, Jazz and Arrangements (University of Music and Performing Arts Vienna)
- Arranger by **Life Ball Vienna 2017**
- Première **Music Theater** **#NoWayBack**

2018

- Graduated **B.A. in Sociology** (University of Vienna)
- Music Preparation / Orchestrator at **World of Hans Zimmer**

2019

- Starts working in **Conservatorio Calasancio de Música y Danza** – Piano, Armonía, Lenguaje Musical, Alemán
- Starts working in **Cinematic Composing** – Instructor and Coordinator

2020

- Orchestrator at **Dreamlight Int. Prod. (Glow & Darkness)**
- Starts working in **Higher Conservatory of Music “Salvador Seguí” of Castellón** – Piano



Catalogue of Works

- a. compositions
- b. music for media
- c. video games
- d. stage
- e. orchestration / arrangements
- f. songwriting & music production

a. *compositions*

Orchestra

- Superb! (2010) 3-3-3-3 / 4-3-3-1 / 3-2-1 / 16-14-12-10-8
- Viola Concerto (2011) Viola Solo, Strings Orchestra
- Piano Concerto (2012) Piano, 2-2-2-2 / 4-2-2-1 / 1-2 / 12-10-8-6-4
- Ed all'improvviso (2013) 3-3-3-3 / 4-3-3-1 / 3-2-1 / 16-14-12-10-8
- Multiverse Symphony (2014) 3-3-3-3 / 4-3-3-1 / 3-2-1 / 16-14-12-10-8

Symphonic Wind Orchestra

- Self-Destruction (2012)

Chamber Music

- Sonata for Cello & Piano (2010) Cello & Pno
- Elegy, Fantasy, Rock (2013) Cello & Pno
- Paradigmen (2015) Bamboo Fl, Pipa, String Quartet
- Trance (2015) Sextet (Soprano, Fl, Cl, Vln, Vc, Pno)
- Life-Beat (2016) Fl, Cl, Vln, Vc, Pno
- Pas de Deux (2016) Bb Cl, Vc, Pno (+ Video)
- Continuum (2018) Organ, T. Tbn

Ensemble

- Tribulaciones (2011) Fl, Ob, Bb Cl, Bs, Hn in F, Pno
 - i. Temas
 - ii. Adagio
 - iii. Frenesí interruptus
- Seven (5 pieces) (2012) Fl, Bb Cl, Perc Set, Pno, Vln, Vla, Vc
- 3 Pieces (2013) Fl, Bb Cl, S. Sax/A. Sax, B. Sax, Bb Tpt, Tbn, Perc Set 1, Perc Set 2, Pno
 - Inflection and resonance
 - aLoyal Song
 - Macchinam



Solo

- Blague nº1 (2011) Piano
- Preludio de Sangre (2015) Piano
- + Danza de la Locura
- State of Mind (2015) Piano (Modular Score + Improvisation)

Lieder

- Recuerdos (2011) Soprano & Piano

Electro-acoustic

- Reflections (2011) Flute + Live Electronics (MaxMSP)
- Arc sur canvas (2013) Cello + Live Electronics (MaxMSP)
- Playing Desk (2013) Electronics + Video
- Electro-Thunder Harp (2016) Harp + Sampler (self-programmed)

Big Band

- Tekamolo (2013)
- Spanish Ballade (2016)

b. *music for media*

Short-film

- Escapar (ES 2011)
- Tagomago (ES 2013) Premiered in Cinema in Spain
- El Torturador (AR 2013) Premiered on Spanish National TV (TVE)
- El juego del escondite (ES 2013) Multiple International Nominations
- Polly (ES 2015) Multiple International Nominations
- Schatten Zero (ES 2017) Multiple International Nominations

Documentaries

- Requiem por los que van a la Universidad (ES 2013)
- España se escribe con B (ES 2013) Web Series



Advertising / Promotional

- Running is our life (2013) Promoting Sportman
- Share & Coach (2014) Social Network for Sports

C. *video games*

Original music

- Adaline (ES 2014) iOS
- Coloré (US 2015) iOS / Android
- Solitaire Klondike (CAN 2015) Android

Sound Design

- FeedUS (2014) Interactive / Integrated Sound Design
- Clockwork Damage (2015) Interactive / Integrated Sound Design
- Witches (2015) Linear Sound Design
- Schools of Magic (2015) Linear Sound Design
- Runemals (2015) Interactive / Integrated Sound Design

d. *stage*

Music Theater

- Momentos VII:
“Bahnhöfe des Lebens” (AT 2014) Dance-Theater with Original music
- #NoWayBack (AT 2017) Original Music and Concept



e. *orchestration / arrangements*

Orchestration

- | | | | |
|-----------------------------------|-------------|-----------------------------|----------------------------------|
| ▪ Rush Title (Hans Zimmer) | (2018) | World of Hans Zimmer | |
| ▪ Time (Inception - Hans Zimmer) | (2018) | World of Hans Zimmer | |
| ▪ Dark Knight Title (Hans Zimmer) | (2018) | World of Hans Zimmer | |
| ▪ Glow and Darkness | (currently) | Netflix Series
3 Seasons | <i>Dreamlight Int.
Prod.</i> |

Arrangements

- | | | | |
|---|--------|---|--|
| ▪ Dancing in the Dark
(Arthur Schwartz / Howard Dietz) | (2017) | Arrangement for Lifeball
Vienna 2017 | |
| ▪ Janoska Symphony
(Frantisek Janoska) | (2018) | Arrangement for Orchestra | |
| ▪ "Italia" (Gabriel Yared) | (2019) | Theme from the Movie "The
Talented Mr. Ripley" | |

f. *songwriting & music production*

Songs

- | | | | |
|----------------------------------|--------|--|-----|
| ▪ Game of Life (feat. Moni Rose) | (2015) | Music, lyrics, recording and
production | Pop |
| ▪ I'm a Minister (feat. Mateus) | (2018) | Music, lyrics and production | Pop |



Professors, Masterclasses and Courses

composition

Main:

- Ferrer Ferran (CSMC)
- Claudia Montero (CSMC)
- Miguel Ángel Berbis (CSMC)
- César Cano (CSMC)
- Reinhard Karger (MDW)
- Christian Mühlbacher (MDW)
- Karlheinz Essl (MDW)

Courses & Masterclasses:

- Toshio Hosokawa
- Héctor Parra
- Beat Furrer
- Georg Friedrich Haas
- Ricardo Llorca
- Anton García Abril
- Cristóbal Halffter

film music

- James Homer
- Alexandre Desplat
- Hans Zimmer
- Danny Elfman
- Reinhard Karger (MDW)

piano

Classical:

- Agustín Martínez (CPMC)
- Juan Carlos Cornelles (CSMC)
- Brenno Ambrosini
- Basilio Fernández
- Carles Marín
- Carlos Apellániz

Jazz:

- Christian Mühlbacher (MDW)
- Paul Urbanek (MDW)

Free Improvisation:

- Manon Liu-Winter (MDW)
- Josep-María Balanyà

music production

- Martin Kreiner (MDW)
- Georg Gabler (MDW)
- Marc Jovani (Cinematic Composing)

other

- Gustavo Dudamel (Conductor)

